

Hi! Is there any shortcut keys in vs code that will shrink or collapse nested code?

Yes, Visual Studio Code features native keyboard shortcuts to collapse (fold) and expand (unfold) nested code blocks.  The Data School

Depending on whether you want to shrink a single section, collapse by specific indentation levels, or close everything at once, you can use the commands listed below. [↗](#)

(Note: For chords like `Ctrl + K Ctrl + 0`, keep holding `Ctrl`, then tap `K`, and then tap `0`).  DEV Community

1. Collapse & Expand Everything [↗](#)

- **Collapse All Code:** `Ctrl + K Ctrl + 0` (Windows/Linux) or `Cmd + K Cmd + 0` (Mac)
- **Expand All Code:** `Ctrl + K Ctrl + J` (Windows/Linux) or `Cmd + K Cmd + J` (Mac)  Reddit · r/vscode +1

2. Collapse by Nesting Levels

If you want to keep top-level code visible but hide deeply nested functions, loops, or objects, you can fold by indentation level:  Medium · QJ Li

- **Fold Level 1** (Main outer blocks): `Ctrl + K Ctrl + 1` (Mac: `Cmd + K Cmd + 1`)
- **Fold Level 2** (First nested layer): `Ctrl + K Ctrl + 2` (Mac: `Cmd + K Cmd + 2`)
- **Fold Level 3** (Second nested layer): `Ctrl + K Ctrl + 3` (Mac: `Cmd + K Cmd + 3`)
- *You can repeat this up to Level 7 (`Ctrl + K Ctrl + 7`).*  Medium · QJ Li +1

3. Collapse the Local Block (Where Your Cursor Is) [↗](#)

- **Collapse Current Block:** `Ctrl + Shift + [` (Windows/Linux) or `Cmd + Option + [` (Mac)

- **Expand Current Block:** `Ctrl + Shift + ]` (Windows/Linux) or `Cmd + Option + ]` (Mac)
- **Toggle Current Block (Fold/Unfold):** `Ctrl + K Ctrl + L` (Windows/Mac)  The Data School +2

4. Collapse Recursively (The Current Block AND All Its Children)

- **Collapse Block & Subregions:** `Ctrl + K Ctrl + [` (Windows/Linux) or `Cmd + K Cmd + [` (Mac)
- **Expand Block & Subregions:** `Ctrl + K Ctrl + ]` (Windows/Linux) or `Cmd + K Cmd + ]` (Mac)  Stack Overflow +1

 **Pro-Tip:** If you prefer using your mouse, you can hold down the `Shift` key while clicking the folding arrow in the editor's left gutter. This will recursively collapse or expand that specific block and every single layer nested inside it.  Reddit · r/vscode +1

Would you like to know how to **change these default keys** to match another editor (like Visual Studio or IntelliJ), or are you looking to configure VS Code to **always open files with code pre-collapsed?**



Thanks. Can you tell more about Ctrl + K combination?

In Visual Studio Code, `Ctrl + K` (or `Cmd + K` on Mac) is not a standalone shortcut. Instead, it acts as a **"chord master key"** or prefix.

When you press `Ctrl + K`, VS Code goes into a waiting state, allowing you to press a second key (or combination) to trigger powerful editing, window management, and navigation commands.

Here are the most useful actions you can unlock using the `Ctrl + K` chord, broken down by category:

1. Code Editing & Selection

- **Cut trailing whitespace:** `Ctrl + K Ctrl + X` (Removes useless spaces at the end of lines)
- **Uppercase selection:** `Ctrl + K Ctrl + U` (Changes selected text to ALL CAPS)
- **Lowercase selection:** `Ctrl + K Ctrl + L` (Changes selected text to lowercase)
- **Trim trailing whitespace:** `Ctrl + K Ctrl + X`

2. Managing Code Comments

- **Add line comment:** `Ctrl + K Ctrl + C` (Adds comment tags to selected lines)
- **Remove line comment:** `Ctrl + K Ctrl + U` (Removes comment tags from selected lines)

3. Editor & Window Management (Splitting Screens)

- **Split editor right:** `Ctrl + K Ctrl + \` (Opens your current file in a side-by-side view)
- **Move editor to next group:** `Ctrl + K Right Arrow` (Pushes your current tab to the split window on the right)
- **Focus another group:** `Ctrl + K Ctrl + Left/Right Arrow` (Jumps your cursor between split windows)
- **Close all unedited files:** `Ctrl + K U` (Closes all tabs that do not have unsaved changes)

4. File & Sidebar Navigation

- **Open active file in File Explorer:** `Ctrl + K R` (Reveals the file you are working on inside your computer's file manager)
- **Keep preview tab open:** `Ctrl + K Enter` (Pin a file opened from the sidebar so it doesn't automatically close when you click a new one)

💡 **Pro-Tip:** You can see every single shortcut tied to this key by opening your Settings. Press `Ctrl + K Ctrl + S` to instantly open the **Keyboard Shortcuts** menu, type `Ctrl+K` into the search bar, and you will see the exact list of what your specific setup supports.

Would you like to know how to create your own **custom** `Ctrl + K` **shortcuts**,
or are you interested in learning shortcuts for **multi-cursor editing**?

